

Replace the workshop label printer?

Which next check would make this replacement decision less uncertain?

Agreement: Both options need a concrete cost and compatibility check before acting.

Conflict: The repair path assumes the fault has a bounded fix; the thermal path assumes its labels last long enough.

Unresolved questions:

Will a repair quote remain below the replacement cost?

Will thermal labels remain readable in the supply cabinet?

Repair the current printer

Confidence: medium

Assumptions:

A replacement roller is available

The intermittent fault is mechanical

Disconfirming evidence:

The fault continued after cleaning

The vendor lists the model as end-of-life

Next check: Ask the repair shop for a fixed parts-and-labour quote.

Buy a compact thermal printer

Confidence: low

Assumptions:

Thermal labels will stay readable in storage

Existing label sizes are compatible

Disconfirming evidence:

A stored sample faded near a window

One supplier lists a different core diameter

Next check: Store a printed sample in the supply cabinet for two weeks and measure the label core.

Borrow a printer

Confidence: low

Assumptions:

A neighbour is available

Disconfirming evidence:

The neighbour travels often

Next check: Ask before Tuesday

This decision packet records uncertainty; it does not rank options.